A FIELD MANUAL BY **GERARD SANS**

go>tech WORLD 2026

A VISION FOR 2027 — 2028

Slow Engineering

How we might build software when agents do most of the typing, *and people keep the say.*

Gerard Sans
Google Developer Expert in AI, Cloud & Angular

GoTech World 2026
10 — 11 November
ROMEXPO, Pavilion B1, Bucharest

I · A DAY IN 2028

Maya's *day*

A staff engineer. A factory of agents. One human beat.



Line weight: how much of a person each shift needs.

MORNING

Decide

Over breakfast, Maya checks her phone. Overnight the factory worked on fourteen small jobs. Eleven passed every check. Two need her.

Each arrives as a short card: what was done, why, and the one question only she can answer. *"Approve the docs, hold the migration."* The phone goes away.

DAY

Design and steer

The best hours go on design. Three agents work in parallel, each in its own copy of the code. One asks for a new library. *"No, use the one we already have."*

A reviewer flags a race condition: two retries, then a person. With the factory busy, she spends an hour with customers.

EVENING

Freeze and dispatch

She freezes the specs and sets tonight's limits. The night queue is sized to what the team can review tomorrow, **not to what the machines could do.**

NIGHT

Quiet work

Few permissions, the company's own hardware. One test fails; it's written down and moved to tomorrow. **Nothing merges at night.**

The morning inbox fits inside her review time, *and a coffee.*

FICTION, FOR ILLUSTRATION

The factory is *running.* Here's what it makes.

2026

More is more.

2028

Less is more.

32.7%

DEBT

of agent pull requests merge within 30 days. For people, **84.4%**.

+91%

BURNOUT

more time on review, for **21%** more tasks done.

6.6%

DECISIONS

of developers would trust AI with **important decisions**.

The agents got fast. *The controls didn't.*

> *"The bottleneck has moved from writing code to trusting it."*
>
> Purna Doddapaneni, Bain & Company, October 2026

Manufacturing learned this long ago. Toyota calls it *jidoka*: when something is wrong, the line stops, the problem is fixed, and nobody has to catch it again. **Slow engineering is jidoka for agents.**

Sources: LinearB, 2026 Software Engineering Benchmarks (8.1M pull requests) · Faros AI, The AI Productivity Paradox, 2025 · Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2026 · Bain & Company, Global Technology Report 2026. Survey and telemetry figures are signals, not proof.

III · THE IDEA

Slow is *not* late.

The factory runs at the speed people can *verify*, not the speed machines can type.

2026 · MORE IS MORE	2028 · SLOW ENGINEERING
Agents running 24/7	→ Shifts sized to tomorrow's review
AI "colleagues" with personas	→ Roles as permissions, held by people
Rules written in the prompt	→ Rules enforced in code
Agents mark their own homework	→ Evidence first, then an independent reviewer
Humans read every diff	→ Humans answer only what needs a human
The dark factory	→ Bounded autonomy

The machines stay fast. What's paced, on purpose, is the work that needs a human decision. You ship more of what was asked for, and less of what you later have to unpick.

Lines to *remember*

01 AI IS INFRASTRUCTURE

AI builds. It never signs.

02 MISSION CONTROL

One control room for the team, not one terminal per person.

03 RULES IN CODE

Let the prompt explain a rule. Never let it enforce one.

04 EVIDENCE, THEN REVIEW

AI finished writing. Humans can't finish reading.

05 THE HUMAN BEAT

The factory keeps the human beat.

06 FAIL SOFT

Nothing fails silently, and nothing ships on a guess.

07 SAFER OVER TIME

Every proven path becomes a routine.

08 WEEKEND TO COMPANY

Experiment freely at home. Earn your way into production.

09 YOUR CONTEXT

Own your context, or rent your memory.

10 EVERY INPUT IS A STRANGER

The working context is sacred.

If I had to keep only one, it would be the tenth. A model can't reliably tell information from orders, so nothing reaches an agent without passing the door first.

Capability is the demo. *Bounded autonomy* is what people buy.

This is a guess, not a forecast, and it isn't tied to any vendor. Most of the pieces exist today. What's missing is putting them together with care. I'd love to hear where you disagree.

LET'S TALK AT GOTECH WORLD 2026

Bucharest, 10 — 11 November

ROMEXPO, Pavilion B1

TUE 10 · CODING AREA

Agentic Engineering: Managing Multi-agent Teams with ADK & MCP

Axiom Masterclass · 10:00 – 17:00

WED 11 · DEVELOPERS STAGE

Google's Managed Agents: Voice-First Mission Control with Gemini Live

Opening Keynote · 10:00 – 10:45

ALL MY LINKS



Gerard Sans is a Computer Science Engineer and Google Developer Expert in AI, Cloud and Angular. He leads Axiom Professional Trainings and organises the NextAI London community. **@gerardsans**

> SHARE FREELY WITH CREDIT · © 2026 GERARD SANS